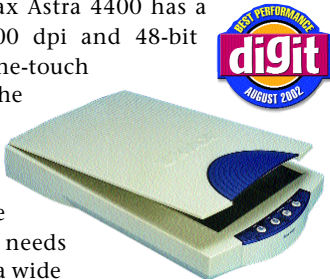


Decision Maker			
You need	Entry-level scanner	Good balance of scan speed and quality	Super fast speed; excellent quality
	To scan documents and photographs occasionally. Quality is not that important	To scan photographs at decent resolutions along with coloured documents and magazine pages	Very high resolution scans which can be used for professional purposes (studios, media houses, etc) and has all features to tweak the image from within the driver
Look for	A minimum optical resolution of 600 dpi and support for 36-bit colour	An optical resolution of 1200 dpi and 48-bit colour depth and one-touch buttons to save time	An optical resolution of 2400 dpi and 48-bit colour depth. The scanner should be bundled with image editing and OCR software
Our pick	Microtek ScanMaker 3800 BenQ SW2 3300U BenQ SW2 4300U	Umax Astra 4400 Microtek ScanMaker V6UPL BenQ ScanPrisa 640BT	HP ScanJet 5470C HP ScanJet 5400C Epson Perfection 1650 Photo
Price range	Rs 4,000 to Rs 5,500	Rs 8,500 to Rs 9,000	Rs 13,000 to Rs 19,000

3,900, it is the cheapest scanner in this comparison test and is an affordable option for those looking for a decent mixture of performance and features at a rock-bottom price.

Umax Astra 4400: The Umax Astra 4400 has a rated resolution of 1200x2400 dpi and 48-bit colour depth. There are three one-touch buttons on the front-panel. The scanner wasn't the fastest but gave good results in the IT8 card test and resolution chart test. It is an excellent buy for the professional or someone who needs good colour reproduction and a wide tonal range, as well as for general office use where it will be used by multiple users—its driver has support for network scanning. The scanner is priced at Rs 8,950 but its top-notch performance makes it worth the price.



Umax Astra 4400: an excellent choice for the professional user

Agfa SnapScan 1212P: Agfa SnapScan 1212P sports an optical resolution of 600x1200 dpi and a 36-bit colour depth. Despite using a parallel interface, it was faster at scanning black and white documents than the SCSI and USB scanners in its category and

also did quite well in the quality tests. Bundled with the scanner are Corel Print House, PageKeeper, Omni-Page LE OCR software and MicroFrontier Colour It—software that will take care of all your imaging, printing and OCR tasks. The scanner is available for just Rs 6,500 which makes it the cheapest in its category.



Agfa SnapScan 1212P: more than adequate for your day-to-day scanning requirements

HP ScanJet 5470C: This sleek scanner's front panel is loaded with buttons which make it very easy to scan in bulk—you won't have to wait for the image application to open for the scanning job to start. The 5470C has a rated resolution of 2400x2400 dpi and 48-bit colour depth. The package includes HP Precisionscan Pro, which is a very good colour calibrating utility, and Readiris, an OCR software. The scanner costs a hefty Rs 17,999, but the price can be easily justified given the performance, bundled software and HP's service network.



HP ScanJet 5470C: every professional's dream

HP ScanJet 5400C: The HP ScanJet 5400C is capable of scanning documents at an optical resolution of 2400x2400 dpi and 48-bit colour depth. The scanner has 11 buttons on the front panel and you can even set the number of copies you want using the + and - buttons. The 5400C was neck and neck throughout our tests with its sibling, the ScanJet 5470C—the difference being that this model is available for Rs 12,999, which makes it an affordable scanner for those looking for a 2400 dpi scanning solution. Couple this with its long list of software and it would be tough for you find a better deal.



HP ScanJet 5400C: a great combination of features and performance at an affordable price



Shopping for a Scanner

- Always check the optical resolution of the scanner and not the interpolated resolution.
- Make sure the scanner comes complete with all connection cables and especially the drivers for your operating system.
- Always cross-check the warranty—whether it is a carry-in or onsite warranty.
- If you often need to scan transparencies, buy a scanner that allows you to connect a transparency adapter.
- Always examine the scanner glass to ensure that it is clean; a dirty scanner glass will drastically affect the scan quality.
- A flexible lid makes it easier to scan books and 3D objects.
- Opt for a scanner that supports 48-bit colour depth.
- Go in for a scanner with a good software bundle—it could save you on buying an image editing and an OCR software.

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